

Part A – Case Study: Cybercrime Research Reflection

While working on this case study related to UPI and online payment fraud, the most surprising aspect for me was that such cybercrimes often depend more on social engineering techniques than on advanced technical hacking methods. As a computer science student, I usually pay more attention to software flaws, system vulnerabilities, and encryption mechanisms. However, this study helped me realize how effectively attackers exploit human emotions and psychology, such as fear, urgency, and trust, to deceive users.

It was particularly eye-opening to understand that even people who are familiar with digital platforms and online tools can become victims of phishing links, fake payment requests, or fraudulent screen-sharing scams. This made me understand that cybersecurity is not only about strong technology but also about user awareness and cautious behavior.

As a result, the key habit I am personally changing is the way I respond to sudden digital payment requests. From now on, I will make it a point to verify the identity of the requester before approving any UPI transaction or scanning any QR code, even if the request appears to come from someone I know. Taking a few extra seconds to confirm the authenticity of the request can serve as an essential layer of personal security and help prevent online fraud.